

4. STATEMENT — COURSES OF ACTION

A course of action is a step or administrative decision to be taken for improvement, follow-up or further action in regard to the problem, policy *etc.* on the basis of the information given in the statement*.

The questions in this section, thus, involve finding the appropriate course of action, assuming the problem or policy being talked about in the statement.

TYPE 1

In this type of questions, a statement is given followed by two courses of action numbered I and II. The candidate is required to grasp the statement, analyse the problem (St policy it mentions and then decide which of the courses of action logically follow.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Ex. 1. Statement

Many cases of cholera were reported from a nearby village.
- Courses of action

I. The question should be raised in the Legislative Assembly.

II. A team of doctors should be rushed to the village.

Sol. Clearly, the disease has to be eradicated. For this, proper and immediate medication and preventive measures by doctors is necessary. So, only course II follows.

- Ex. 2. Statement

Japan is not likely to grant India's request for a \$500 million fast disbursing loan for the current year.
- Courses of action

I. India should approach other countries to get a loan.

II. India should persuade Japan to grant the loan to meet its immediate demand of foreign exchange.

Sol. Clearly, to remedy the problem, India can either stress its urgency and persuade Japan itself or it shall look to another country for the same purpose. Thus, either I or II course of action can follow.

- Ex. 3. Statement

People residing in some tribal areas are far from education.
- Courses of action

I. Schools for children and adults, should be opened there,

II. Social workers should be entrusted with the job of educating them.

Sol. Clearly, to make permanent arrangements for education in remote tribal areas, schools have to be opened in those very areas. Education by social workers shall be a temporary remedy. So, only the course of action I follows.

- Ex. 4. Statement

India today is midstream in its demographic transition. In the last 60 years there has been an almost continuous decline in mortality; while fertility has declined over the last 20 years. The consequence is that there has been a rapid growth in population over the last 50 years.
- Courses of action

I. India should immediately revitalise its family planning programme.

II. The Government should immediately launch a massive education programme through mass media highlighting the implication of population growth at the present rate.

Sol. Clearly, to face the problem of the ever growing population, an effective family planning programme, for the people to have small families, is a must. Education shall further stress the advantages of having less number of children and the disasters of the fast growth in population. Thus, both the courses of action will follow.

EXERCISE 4A

Directions : In each question below is given a statement followed by two courses of action numbered I and II. You have to assume everything in the statement to be true, then decide which of the two suggested courses of action logically follows for pursuing.

Give answer (a) if only I follows; (b) if only II follows; (c) if either I or II follows; (d) if neither I nor II follows and (e) if both I and II follow.

1. Statement

There are more than 200 villages in the hill area of Uttar Pradesh which are severely damaged due to cyclone and it causes an extra burden of Rs 200 crore on State Government for relief and rehabilitation work. (Bank P.O. 1993)

Courses of action

I. People of hill area should be shifted to other safer places.

II. State Government should ask more financial support from Central Government.
2. Statement

The Minister said that the teachers are still not familiarised with the need, importance and meaning of population education in the higher education system. They are not even clearly aware about their role and responsibilities in the population education programme. (Bank P.O. 1996)

Courses of action

I. Population education programme should be included in the college curriculum.

II. Orientation programme should be conducted for teachers on population education.
3. Statement

A group of school students was reported to be enjoying at a picnic spot during school hours.

Courses of action

I. The Principal should contact the parents of those students and tell them about the incident with a real warning for future.

II. Some disciplinary action must be taken against those students and all other students should be made aware of it.
4. Statement

Financial stringency prevented the State Government from paying salaries to its employees since April this year.

Courses of action

I. The State Government should immediately curtail the staff strength by 30%.

II. The State Government should reduce wasteful expenditure and arrange to pay the salaries of its employees.
5. Statement

The State Government has decided to declare Kala Azar as a notifiable disease under the Epidemics Act. Family members or neighbours of the patient are liable to be punished in case they did not inform the State authorities.

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| | Courses of action | <p>I. Efforts should be made to effectively implement the Act.</p> <p>II. The cases of punishment should be propagated through mass media so that more people become aware of the stern actions.</p> |
| 6. Statement | | <p>One of the problems facing the food processing industry is the irregular supply of raw material. The producers of raw material are not getting a reasonable price.</p> |
| | Courses of action | <p>I. The government should regulate the supply of raw material to other industries also.</p> <p>II. The government should announce an attractive package to ensure regular supply of raw material for food processing industry. (Bank P.O. 1993)</p> |
| 7. Statement | | <p>The Officer Incharge of a Company had a hunch that some money was missing from the safe.</p> |
| | Courses of action | <p>I. He should get it recounted with the help of the staff and check it with the balance sheet.</p> <p>II. He should inform the police.</p> |
| 8. Statement | | <p>The Government has decided not to provide financial support to voluntary' organisations from next five year plan and has communicated that all such organisations should, raise funds to meet their financial needs.</p> |
| | Courses of action | <p>I. Voluntary organisations should collaborate with foreign agencies.</p> <p>II. They should explore other sources of financial support. (Bank P.O. 1993)</p> |
| 9. Statement | | <p>Some serious blunders were detected in the Accounts section of a factory.</p> |
| | Courses of action | <p>I. An efficient team of auditors should be appointed to check the Accounts.</p> <p>II. A show cause notice should be issued to all the employees involved in the irregularity.</p> |
| 10. Statement | | <p>If the retired Professors of the same Institutes are also invited to deliberate on restructuring of the organisation, their contribution may be beneficial to the Institute.</p> |
| | Courses of action | <p>I. Management may seek opinion of the employees-before calling retired professors.</p> <p>II. Management should involve experienced people for the systematic restructuring of the organisation. (Bank P.O. 1996)</p> |
| 11. Statement | | <p>Doordarshan is concerned about the quality of its programmes particularly in view of stiff competition it is facing from STAR and other satellite TV channels and is contemplating various measures to attract talent for its programmes.</p> |
| | Courses of action | <p>I. In an effort to attract talent, the Doordarshan has decided to revise its fee structure for the artists.</p> <p>II. The fee structure should not be revised until other electronic media also revise it. (Bank P.O. 1993)</p> |
| 12. Statement | | <p>Youngsters are often found staring at obscene posters.</p> |
| | Courses of action | <p>I. Children should be punished and penalized if they are found doing so.</p> |

20. Statement	Exporters in the capital are alleging that commercial banks are violating a Reserve Bank of India directive to operate a post shipment export credit denominated in foreign currency at international interest rates from January this year.
Course* of action	I. The officers concerned in the commercial banks are to be suspended. II. The RBI should be asked to stop giving such directives to commercial banks. (Bank P.O. 19t2)
21. Statement	The police department has come under a cloud with recent revelations that at least two senior police officials are suspected to have been involved in the illegal sale of a large quantity of weapons from the state police armoury.
Courses of action	I. A thorough investigation should be ordered by the State Government to bring out all those who are involved into the illegal sale of arms. 11. State police armoury should be kept under Central Government's control.
22. Statement	India's performance in the recent Olympic Games was very poor. Not even a single medal could be bagged by the players Government has spent Rs 5 crores in training and deputing a team of players to participate in the Olympic Games.
Courses of action	I. India should stop sending players to the future Olympic Games. II. Government should immediately set up an enquiry commission to find out the reason for India's dismal performance. (Bank P.O. 1992)
23. Statement	Courts take too long in deciding important disputes of various departments.
Courses of action	I. Courts should be ordered to speed up matters. II. Special powers should be granted to officers to settle disputes concerning their department.
24. Statement	The Committee has criticized the Institute for its failure to implement a dozen of regular programmes despite an increase in the staff strength and not drawing up a firm action plan for studies and research.
Courses of action	I. The broad objectives of t^e Institute should be redefined to implement a practical action plan. II. The Institute should give a report on reasons for not having implemented the planned programmes.
25. Statement	Mr. X, an active member of the Union, often insults his superiors in the office with his rude behaviour.
Courses of action	I. He should be transferred to some other department. II. The matter should be referred to the Union.
26. Statement	A leading U.S. multinational engineering and construction firm is keen to invest in India in a variety of sectors ranging from power to land management. (Bank P.O. 1992)
Courses of action	I. Such multinational companies should not be allowed to operate in India.

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- 34. Statement** The Central Bureau of Investigation receives the complaint of an officer taking bribe to do the duty he is supposed to.
- Courses of action**
- I. CBI should try to catch the officer red-handed and then take a strict action against him.
 - II. CBI should wait for some more complaints about the officer to be sure about the matter.
- 35. Statement** The Finance Minister submits his resignation a month before the new budget is to be presented in the Parliament.
- Courses of action**
- I. The resignation should be accepted and another person should be appointed as the Finance Minister.
 - II. The resignation should not be accepted.
- 36. Statement** The Librarian finds some cases in which the pages from certain books issued from the library, are torn.
- Courses of action**
- I. The Librarian should keep a record of books issued by each student, and if the pages are found torn, strict measures should be taken against the child who had been issued that book.
 - II. Some funds should be collected from the children collectively to renovate the library.
- 37. Statement** The Asian Development Bank has approved a \$ 285 million loan to finance a project to construct coal ports by Paradip and Madras Port Trusts. (Bank P.O. 1992)
- Courses of action**
- I. India should use financial assistance from other international financial organisations to develop such ports in other places.
 - II. India should not seek such financial assistance from the international financial agencies.
- 38. Statement** The Secretary lamented that the electronic media was losing its credibility and that it should try to regain it by establishing better communications with the listeners and the viewers. He also emphasised the need for training to improve the functioning. (Bank P.O. 1993)
- Courses of action**
- I. Efforts should be made to get organised feedback on the programme.
 - II. The critical areas in which the staff requires training should be identified.
- 39. Statement** The killer enteric fever has so far claimed 100 lives in some tribal villages in M.P. during the past three weeks.
- Courses of action**
- I. The residents of these villages should immediately be shifted to a non-infected area.
 - II. The Government should immediately send a medical squad to this area to restrict spread of the killer disease
- 40. Statement** Orissa and Andhra Pradesh have agreed in principle to set up a joint control board for better control, management and productivity of several inter-state multipurpose projects.
- I. Other neighbouring states should set up such control boards.
 - II. The proposed control board should not be allowed to function as such joint boards are always ineffective. (Bank P.O. 1992)

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29. (a): Clearly, if allowed to continue without being punished, the shopkeeper would create a problem elsewhere. So, course I shall follow.
30. (6) : Since the act has been repeated despite various warnings, so course I would only be another warning and would not help. Severe punishment to set example for him and others is inevitable. Thus, course II shall follow.
31. *id*) : What is necessary is the preventive measures to protect the passengers and pay them adequate compensation. So, none of the courses follows.
32. *ie*) : To educate all children, enforcement of education is necessary. Also, the reason is that they are employed. So. ban on such employment is also needed Thus, both the courses follow.
33. *id*): Clearly, the situation demands maintaining peace in the country so as to restore the original number of tourists and not suffer a fall in the revenue earned. Thus, none of the courses follows.
34. *ia*): Clearly, one complaint is enough for a wrong doing. This should be confirmed by ditching the guilty red handed and then strict action taken against him So, only course I follows
35. *ib*): Clearly, an already working Finance Minister shall know better all the plans and resources of the Government and he alone can present a suitable budget So. course II should be followed.
36. (a) : Clearly, precaution should be taken to catch the guilty person and punish him for the act. This alone will help curb the wrong practice. So. only course I will follow.
37. (a): Clearly, such projects shall be an asset and a source of income to the country later on. So, course I shall follow.
38. (e) : Clearly, both the courses directly follow from the prerequisites mentioned in the statement
39. *ib*): Clearly, the first course of action is vague because if people are shifted to a non-infected area, the infection will spread there as well. The remedy is only to fight the disease and restrict its spread. So. course II will follow.
40. *va*): The effectiveness of such Control Boards is established by the fact that Orissa and A.P. have agreed to it for better control of its multipurpose projects. So. only course I follows.
41. (d): Clearly, none of the courses of action follows because firstly, the notification is issued to promote the natural environment is issued to promote the natural environment and so cannot be withdrawn and secondly, the sanctuaries etc., cannot be shifted.
42. (a): Clearly, proper supervision alone can see the development in practice So. only course I follows.
43. (a) : Clearly, the urgent need is to detect the blunder and improve it. Reasons do not matter much. So. only course I follows.
44. *id*): Clearly, none of the courses of action is a suitable follow up of the Government's act against defaultation. So, neither I nor II follows.

EXERCISE 4B

Directions : In each question below is given a statement followed by three courses of action numbered I, II and III. You have to assume everything in the statement to be true, then decide which of the three given suggested courses of action logically follows for pursuing.

Questions 1 to 5

(Bank P.O. 1995)

1. Statement

In one of the worst accidents in railway level crossing fifty people died when a bus carrying them collided on to a running train.

Courses of action

- I.** The train driver should immediately be suspended,
II. The driver of the bus should be tried in court for negligence on his part.
III. The railway authority should be asked to man all its level crossings.

- (a) None follows (b) Only I and II follow (c) Only III follows
 (d) Only II and III follow (e) None of these

2. Statement

There was a spurt in criminal activities in the city during the recent festival season.

Courses of action

- I.** The police should immediately investigate into the causes of this increase.
II. In future the police should take adequate precaution to avoid recurrence of such situation during festival
III. The known criminals should be arrested before any such season.

- (a) None follows (b) Only I and II follow (c) Only II and III follow
 (d) All follow (e) None of these

3. Statement

A mass mortality of shrimps in ponds on entire Andhra coast has recently been reported due to the presence of a virus.

Courses of action

- I.** The water of the ponds affected should immediately be treated for identifying the nature of the virus.
II. The catching of shrimps from the ponds should temporarily be stopped.
III. The fishermen should be asked to watch for the onset of such phenomenon in nature,

- (a) Only I follows (b) Only I and II follow (c) All follow
 (d) Only II and III follow (e) None of these

4. Statement

The weather bureau has through a recent bulletin forecast heavy rainfall during the next week which may cause water logging in several parts of the city.

Courses of action

- I.** The bulletin should be given wide publicity through the mass media.
II. The civic authority should keep in readiness the pumping system for removal of water from these parts.
III. The people should be advised to stay indoors during the period.

- (a) None follows (b) Only I and II follow (c) Only II follows
 (d) Only II and III follow (e) None of these

5. Statement

The world will have to feed more than 10 billion people in the next century of whom half will be in Asia and will eat rice as their staple.

Courses of action

- I.** More funds should immediately be allocated for rice research to help ensure adequate supply.
II. The people in Asia should be encouraged to change their food habit.
III. The rice should be grown in countries outside Asia to meet the demand.

- (a) Only I and II follow (b) Only II and III follow (c) All follow
 (d) Only I and III follow (e) None of these

Questions 6 to 10

(Bank P.O. 1993)

- 6. Statement** If the faculty members also join the strike, there is going to be a serious problem.
- Courses of action** L The faculty members should be persuaded not to go on strike,
 II. Those faculty members who join the strike should be suspended.
 III. The management should not worry about such small things,
 (a) None follows (6) Only I follows (c) Only I and II follow
 (d) Only II and III follow (e) All follow
7. **Statement** Higher disposal costs encourage those who produce waste to
 > look for cheaper ways to get rid of it.
- Courses of action** I. The disposal costs should be made higher,
 II. The disposal costs should be brought down.
 III. A committee should be set up to study the details in this respect,
 (a) All follow (6) Only I follows (c) Only II follows
 (d) Either I or II follows (e) Only II and III follow
8. **Statement** The army has been alerted in the district following floods
 triggered by incessant rains.
- Courses of action** I. Relief to flood affected people should be arranged,
 II. Supply of food articles should be arranged.
 III. Adequate medical facilities should be arranged,
 (a) None follows (6) Only 1 follows (c) Only II follows
 (</) Only 1 and III follow (e) All follow
9. **Statement** Faced with a serious resource crunch and a depressing overall
 i economic scenario, Orissa is unlikely to achieve the targetted
 percent compound annual growth rate during the 8th plan.
- Courses of action** I. The target growth should be reduced for the next year,
 II. The reasons for the failure should be studied.
 III. Orissa's performance should be compared with that of other states,
 (a) None follows (6) Only I follows (c) Only II and III follow
 (d) Only I and III follow (e) All follow
10. **Statement** Over 27,000 bonded labourers identified and freed are still
 awaiting rehabilitation.
- Courses of action** I. More cases of bonded labourers should be identified,
 H. Till the proper rehabilitation facilities are available, the
 bonded labourers should not be freed.
 III. The impediments in the way of speedy and proper rehabilitation
 of bonded labourers should be removed,
 (a) None follows (6) Only I follows (c) Only II follows
 (d) Only III follows (e) Only II and III follow

Questions 11 to 16

(S.B.I.P.O. 1994)

11. **Statement** In the Teachers Day function, Shri Roy, a state awardee and
 a retired Principal, had questioned the celebration of Teacher's
 Day in "today's materialistic world".

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- (a) None follows (6) Only I and III follow (c) All follow
 (rf) Only II and III follow (ie) None of these

Questions 21 to 25**(Bank P.O. 1995)****21. Statement**

Drinking water supply to New Bombay has been suspended till further orders from Maharashtra Pollution Control Board following pollution of Patalganga river, caused by discharge of effluents from some chemical industries.

Courses of action

- I. The industries responsible for discharging effluents into the river should be asked to close down immediately.
- II. The river water should immediately be treated chemically before resuming supply.
- III. The Pollution Control Board should check the nature of effluents being discharged into the river by industries at regular intervals.

- (a) All follow (6) Only I follows (c) Only II and III follow
 (d) Only III follows (<?) None of these

22. Statement

The Department of Education has recommended that the primary level admission to Government and Government aided schools should be done purely by random selection and not by admission tests. This is necessitated as the number of admission seekers are much more than the available seats.

Courses of action

- I. The Government should instruct the private schools also to follow the same practice.
- II. The Government should set up an independent body to regulate the primary level admissions.
- III. The schools should be asked to select students only from those who stay in the neighbouring area of the school,

- (a) None follows (6) Only 1 and II follow (c) Only II and III follow
 (d) Only II follows (e) None of these

23. Statement

The vehicular traffic has increased so much in the recent past that it takes at least two hours to travel between the city and the airport during peak hours.

Courses of action

- I. Non-airport bound vehicles should not be allowed to ply on the road connecting the city and the airport.
- II. The load of vehicular traffic should be diverted through various link roads during peak hours.
- III. The departure and arrival of flights should be regulated so as to avoid congestion during peak hours.

- (a) Only I follows (6) Only II follows (c) Only I and II follow
 (d) All follow (e) None of these

24. Statement

Due to cancellation of a huge export order for not adhering to the time frame, the company is likely to get into incurring losses in the current financial year.

Courses of action

- I. The officer in charge of the production should be immediately suspended.

- II. The goods manufactured for the export order should be sold to other party.
- III. The company should change its machinery to maintain the time frame.

- (a) None follows ib) Only II follows ic) Only I and II follow
- id) All follow ie) None of these

25. Statement

A devastating earthquake has ravaged the city killing hundreds of people and rendering many more homeless.

Courses of action

- I. The entry of outsiders into the city should be stopped immediately.
- II. The civic administration should immediately make alternate temporary housing arrangement for the victims.
- III. The affected people should immediately be shifted to a safer place,

- (a) Only I follows (b) Only II and III follow
- (c) Only 111 follows (d) Only either II or III follows
- ie) None of these

ANSWERS

- 1. (c) 2. (6) 3. (a) 4. id) 5. (a) 6. ib) 7. ie) 8. (*> 9. ic) 10. id)
- 11. ie) 12. (a) 13. id) 14. id) 15. (6) 16. ic) 17. ib) 18. id) 19. id) 20. id)
- 21. ic) 22. ia) 23. ib) 24. ib) 25. <6)